of one's prescribed actions but in a spirit of awareness of God as the ultimate cause of one's very being.

Some devotional religions tend towards social inclusivity since anyone, be they high-caste Brahmins or outcastes, is capable of emotion. For this reason, it may be treated with suspicion by the orthodox.

Further reading: Hardy 1983

**Bhartrihari** (c. 430–80 CE): author of the *Vakyapadiya*, *Bhartrihari* was a Sanskrit grammarian who taught a version of philosophical monism. Whereas most non-dualistic (***Advaita***) philosophers identified the Absolute Reality (***Brahman***) with undifferentiated, static consciousness, *Bhartrihari* understood it as the undifferentiated essence of language (*shabda*) and meaning (***sphota***; 'the bursting forth of meaning). The Absolute-as-Meaning appears as many subjects, acts and objects of awareness in time and space through its principal autonomous power called time (*kala-shakti*). Meaning, although unitary, appears in sequences due to time. It appears to have parts because sound is differently manifested in time and space. Language and consciousness are inseparable, language being the creative 'vibration' in all awareness. *Bhartrihari* says that every cognition is saturated by words. If the identity of knowledge and words ceased, consciousness would not illuminate. It is this identity that makes reflective awareness possible.

*Bhartrihari*'s basic insight in his theory of language is that the sentence is the basic linguistic fact and that individual words are grammarians' abstractions. Sentences and contexts, rather than individual words, are the actual vehicles of language. The primary linguistic fact is the sentence with an undivided meaning (***sphota***).

There are three stages of metaphysical and linguistic evolution from the undifferentiated 'Semantic-Absolute'.